



# KNOW HOW



**Q I am new to Linux and have recently installed it on my computer. I want to know if I can run Windows programs and games on it? If yes, then please explain how to go about it.**

—Nordon Lama, Sikkim

There are emulators that can run some of the Windows programs and games on Linux. WINE is perhaps the best amongst the lot. To get started with the installation, the best option is to download the precompiled binary package for your Linux distribution from [www.winehq.org/site/download](http://www.winehq.org/site/download). Note that not all Windows-based apps will run.

**Q I have been using Thunderbird 2.0 as my main e-mail client. I have set about 35-40 message**

**filters for my incoming mails. A few days back I bought a new laptop and moved all my data, including the mails. Now the problem is that I am unable to export my filters to the new set-up. Is there any option in Thunderbird that allows me to export/import message filters or do I have to go through the pain of creating each of them again?**

Thunderbird does not have any function built-in to import or export message filters. There is a Thunderbird extension available [<https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/thunderbird/addon/2474>] that has the functionality you want. You need to download the .xpi file and install the extension on Thunderbird, on both your systems.

After installing the extension, open *Tools→Message Filters*. Click *Export Filters* to export the message filters for the selected account. Copy the file over to the new system and again go to *Tools→Import Filters* to import message filters.

**Q I am facing a problem with OpenOffice.org. Whenever I create a new document, it saves it in the .odt format, by default. This creates problems for other people who use Microsoft Office. Can you help me in setting my OpenOffice.org to**

**save documents by default in the .doc format?**

—Sneha Basu, Kolkata

To set OpenOffice.org to save documents in the .doc format by default, follow the steps given below:

1. Go to *Tools→Options* to open the *Options* window.
2. Here, on the left pane, expand the category called *Load/Save*, and click on the *General* menu.
3. Now look for an option called '*Always save as*' and select your option there.

From now on, your new documents will be saved in the .doc format by default.

**Q I am using Firefox 3.0 and whenever I type a few characters of a URL, Firefox suggests a URL from the list of previously visited sites in the address bar's drop-down history menu. I want to remove some URLs from the list of previously visited sites. Is it possible to do so without deleting all?**

—Parkash Singh, Ludhiana

You can just use the down arrow key to select the URL you want to delete—it'll appear in your location bar. Instead of hitting *Enter* to go to the website, use the *Delete* key. Firefox won't suggest the same URL again. 

[www.linuxforu.com](http://www.linuxforu.com)

**More and more IT Managers are adopting Open Source. What about You?**

Read LINUX For You: Asia's Leading Open Source Magazine

